Icebreaker Activity

“Beyond Stereotypes”

Teachers Explain to the students that the goal of the game is to discuss stereotypes and share their personal experiences to see if these stereotypes are true or false.

They will distribute card to each group of participants.

Each participant or group reads the stereotype on their card and discusses with others to determine if the stereotype is true or false, sharing anecdotes and personal experiences.

After the discussions in small groups, gather everyone and ask each group to share what they have learned or discovered.

They can Vote to say if the stereotype is mostly true or false according to their experiences.

Challenges: Add fun challenges related to the stereotypes. For example, ask someone to demonstrate a traditional dance or talk about the typical cuisine of their country.

Examples of Stereotypes

“These examples of stereotypes do not reflect the reality of each individual and can be reductive. It is important to approach them with a critical mind and to seek to know people beyond the clichés.”

Belgians

1. **Beer and chocolate lovers**: Belgians are known for their love of beer and chocolate, products for which they are world-renowned.
2. **Distinctive accent**: French-speaking Belgians are often teased for their unique French accent.
3. **Belgian fries**: It is often said that Belgians invented fries and that they eat a lot of them.
4. **Manneken Pis**: This statue is often used to symbolize the humor and laid-back attitude of Belgians.
5. **Limited cuisine:** It is sometimes said that Belgian cuisine is limited to chocolate, fries, and waffles.

Greeks

1. **Philosophers and historians**: Greeks are often perceived as very intellectual due to their rich philosophical and historical heritage.
2. **Passionate and expressive**: Greeks are said to be very passionate and expressive, especially in their way of speaking and gesturing.
3. **Mediterranean cuisine**: Greeks are associated with healthy and tasty food, with dishes like moussaka and Greek salad.
4. **Hospitality**: Greeks are often seen as very hospitable and welcoming to foreigners.

5. **Party lovers:** Greeks are often perceived as loving to party, due to the bouzoukia culture and the many local festivals.

Spanish

1. **Siesta**: It is commonly thought that Spanish take a nap every day.
2. **Flamenco and bullfighting**: Flamenco dancing and bullfighting are often seen as cultural symbols of Spain.
3. **Lively nightlife**: Spaniards are often perceived as loving to party late into the night, with a very active nightlife.
4. **Paella**: Paella is often considered the national dish of Spain, although this is a simplification of the country's culinary diversity.
5. **Drink a lot**: Spaniards are perceived as drinking a lot.

La Réunion

1. **Cultural melting pot:** Due to its history, La Réunion is often seen as a melting pot of European, African, Indian, and Chinese cultures.
2. **Relaxed island life:** Réunionnais are perceived as having a more relaxed and less stressed lifestyle.
3. **Spicy cuisine:** Réunionnais cuisine is known for being rich in spices and flavors.
4. **Music and dance lovers:** Music and dance, especially séga and maloya, are important elements of Réunionnais culture.
5. Nature lovers: The people of Réunion are often seen as very close to nature, due to the island's stunning landscapes and popular outdoor activities like hiking.